



Universal Memory

What is Universal Memory?

Universal Memory approaches memory storage in a radically different way. Universal Memory is the term given to the next wave of storage solutions that are about to hit the world.

Why do you need Universal Memory?

The next generation of memory devices plan to replace the current generation by outperforming current storage solutions in two basic aspects of memory storage. The first aspect is power consumption, and the second aspect is the density of memory. This generation of low-power, high density memories will probably be able to store memory even without electricity running through them.

Which companies are involved?

The list is pretty long. IBM, HP, Motorola are all researching different universal memory strategies. Samsung and Toshiba are also in the race. Companies that specialise only in memory solutions like Everspin and Hynix are obviously involved. A company called Nantero has developed promising wafers with 10 billion bits of memory.

How will it be done?

Current research have different approaches in different labs. One approach is to use the nanoscale structures on the silicon wafers themselves. Other approaches include molecular memory and magnetic random access memory.

When will we see it?

Predictions vary from 2011 to 2020.

Will it be any good?

Portable devices stand to benefit the most. The memory promises to store all the data in any DVD ever made in a single laptop sized box.

reduce these problems, the cables are buried in the floor of the ocean using special under sea ploughs. However, in rocky bottoms and over undersea cliffs, the cables are still exposed. 2. Cables with 10 Gbps bandwidth were laid at a cost of \$27,000 per km in 1999. Do the math.

DOWN WITH OPEN SOURCE

Microsoft Launches BizSpark

They say all big things begin with an idea. And when it comes to successful technology ventures, some of the biggest have their roots in India. Microsoft is now eyeing this very potential

basically undercutting that advantage. Besides this, the program will also provide access to technical support and marketing visibility from Microsoft, as well as support through a select group of network partners — industry associations, government agencies, university incubators and investors — chartered with advancing entrepreneurialism. In India, these partnerships include The Indus Entrepreneurs (TiE), NEN, Proto, NASSCOM and IDG Ventures, a venture capital firm. Other VC firms supporting the initiative include Draper Fisher Jurvetson (DFJ), Helion Venture Partners and Accel Partners. Virtually everything a startup needs to build a web service (many of the tools and software



market with the launch of BizSpark. The program targets early stage software startups, with resources including access to Microsoft platform software and development tools with no upfront costs. As you've probably figured the program is a bid to keep the open source mafia at bay. It is no secret that startups are very cost-conscious. Given the relative lack of cost-effective software solutions, they often tend to veer towards open source. Microsoft understands the price-attraction of open source, and hence, it is

compete with open source alternatives, such as MySQL) is being offered to startups for free for three years. The idea, they say, is to create a vibrant startup ecosystem in India.

STILL KICKING

New lease of life for Windows XP

Big technology corps often phase out their older products to make way for newer ones.

They first begin by pulling the plug on sales and then eventually stop support. January 31, 2009 was listed as the last day that anyone could buy XP, but Microsoft has told its system builder partners that they will be allowed to continue to sell XP after cut-off date. In what is being called the flexible inventory programme, distributors can place their last orders for Windows XP OEM licenses by January 31, 2009, and take delivery against those orders upto May 30. Until then, distributors would have to buy as many XP licenses as they could afford before the cut off date and sell them after the deadline. Apparently distributors are quite happy with the new arrangement as they don't have to hand over cash for the new licences until they have already sold them.

Software companies are still softies when it comes to phasing out older products. Take the case of processor manufacturers — Intel does not manufacture its Pentium II and III lines anymore. Even if you were to say "hey I use my comp only as a word processor, I don't need quad core speed. Can I get a Pentium II for cheap?" Well no you can't. Not from the manufacturer at least.

About discontinuing support Microsoft says this on its web site, "Microsoft is retiring support for these products because they are outdated and can expose customers to security risks. We recommend that customers who are still running Windows 98 or Windows Me upgrade to a newer, more secure Microsoft operating system, such as Windows XP, as soon as possible." ■